



bazaar

New Quadro FX5800 from Nvidia has 240 parallel CUDA processing cores, 4 GB high speed shader RAM and cost around \$3300

Thermaltake MK+ Armor

A Mightily Shield

Thermaltake is known for making expensive high-end cabinets intended for the gaming audience and has a series called the Armor series of cabinets. One of the recent additions to this line is the Armor+ MX, a slightly cheaper cabinet, which is a mid tower cabinet with some unique features to offer gaming enthusiasts.

One eSATA, two USB, a microphone and headphones port and the power and reset buttons are located on the top of the cabinet, towards the front. The reset button is tiny and difficult to push in comparison to the power button.

There is a unique mechanism to open the side panel, first the two thumb screws behind and then there are two clips that you need to slide forward to open. The panel just snaps into place on closing and is simple and easy to use. The design is well considered and the good thing about these clips is that you don't even need to bother with the thumb screws.

The interiors are neatly setup. The PSU, which needs to be mounted on top, has its own support beam. This beam can also be removed for the convenience of setting up your PC and cable management. The hard drive bays have their own trays and the entire cage can also be removed. The

drives bays give you easy loading and you don't even require to use screws when installing hard drives or even optical drives. Along with screwless drive bays there are also screwless PCI slots, which really are great and save you considerable time and effort.

This cabinet has a total of three fans, one 120 mm for intake, one 120 mm for exhaust and a 230 mm side intake fan. We feel that the inclusion of a top or bottom fan would have been a bonus for this cabinet. This cabinet is a bit pricey at Rs. 7,000 and you might be better off going for something else such as the CM 690.

Specifications:

Dimensions: 21.1 x 9.4 x 19.3 inch (H x W x D), Front Door Material: Aluminium / Chassis: 0.8 mm SECC, Motherboards supported: Micro ATX, Standard ATX

Ratings

Features: 7.5
Performance: 7
Build quality: 6
Value for money: 6
Overall: 6.5



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Datacolor Spyder3 Elite

Colour perfect

Anyone working in a professional computer graphics development environment will tell you the importance of accurate colours. This is a problem often ignored. To get these perfect colours on a PC monitor or TV, you need to calibrate it. That's where the Spyder 3 Elite comes in. It's the top-of-the-line calibrating unit for displays and projectors. It's something we used thoroughly through the LCD and Plasma TV test a few months back for both testing and to give the screens an even playing ground.

The package comes with the main calibrating unit, a stand and the software required to operate it. The hardware connects through a USB connector. A balance weight is attached so you can easily hang the device on your screen if you don't use the suction cups that come with it. For LCDs with delicate surfaces, suspending the device this way is required. The hardware also has a small sensor facing the front of the device to measure the ambient light.

Once the software is installed, the device is detected easily. The software works by displaying a set of colours on screen which are detected by the hardware sensor. You are first required to check

boxes in the software to tell it all the controls available for your TV or monitor – RGB values, colour temperatures, etc. Once this is done, you make changes to the values for as the software requests. Eventually, Spyder 3 makes changes to the colour profile on your system that calibrate your screen and gets you as close as possible to the optimum colours.

We really liked the results that the Spyder 3 Elite and it's something that lets you get multiple screens to look very alike each other. That's something very important in professional work places and it's highly recommended that you get one for your studio. It's also very good to calibrate your PC monitors and televisions.

The cost for the Spyder3 Elite is Rs. 20,800 which is somewhat on the high-side given the software limitations.

Specifications:

USB connectivity, Dimensions: 1.5 x 3.5 x 4.0-inches
Requirements: Windows XP, Windows Vista, Mac OS X (10.3 and higher), 100 MB free space

Ratings

Features: 7
Performance: 8



Build quality: 7
Value for money: 6
Overall: 7

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